Willamette Falls Roofing

The Oregon Homeowner's Roof Replacement Guide

From "is it time?" to a signed contract you feel good about. Written for Willamette Valley weather and Oregon's contractor rules.

Inside: signs it's time · materials for Oregon · what it costs · vetting a CCB-licensed roofer · reading a bid · permits & HOAs · insurance & storms · moss care · checklists

Edition: October 2026. Willamette Falls Roofing is a local roofing information site, not a roofing contractor. Cost figures are published third-party estimates (sources listed); only a licensed contractor's written bid is a price.
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1. Is it time? Repair vs. replace

Most roofs don't fail all at once. They give you years of hints. Here's how to read them.

Signs a repair is probably enough

- One leak, in one spot, after a specific event (windstorm, falling limb)
- A few missing or lifted shingles
- A cracked rubber boot around a plumbing vent
- Flashing pulled away at a chimney or wall
- The roof is in the first two-thirds of its expected life

Signs it's time to replace

- Asphalt roof 20–25+ years old, especially under shade
- Curling, cupping or cracked shingles across whole slopes
- Granules piling up in gutters and at downspout outlets
- Leaks in more than one place, or recurring after repairs
- Soft, spongy decking, or sagging between rafters
- Daylight in the attic; dark, damp or moldy sheathing
- Moss so established it has lifted shingle edges

> **Rule of thumb:** if you're paying for repairs every year on an old roof, ask a roofer to price both a repair and a replacement, and compare the cost over the next five years.

Five-minute self-check (from the ground and attic)

☐ Walk around with binoculars: missing, curled or dark patchy shingles?

☐ Look in the gutters for granules (they look like coarse sand)

☐ Check ceilings in upper rooms and closets for stains

☐ In the attic on a sunny day: any daylight? Any wet or dark wood?

☐ Bathroom fans: do they vent outside, or just into the attic?

☐ Note the roof's age (check permits, home inspection or seller disclosures)

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2. Materials for Oregon weather

West of the Cascades, a roof's enemies are steady rain, shade, moss and wind-driven storms, more than heat or hail. Installed costs below are published per-square-foot ranges (sources on page 8).

Material	Installed $/sq ft of roof	Expected life	Good to know
Architectural asphalt	$4.50–$9	Commonly rated ~25–30+ yrs	Most common; competitive bids; moss and poor ventilation shorten life
Standing-seam metal	$9–$16 (local bids can run higher)	Commonly 40–70 yrs	Sheds needles and moss; fewer installers; check HOA rules
Synthetic shake	$12–$20	Manufacturer dependent	Cedar look, far less upkeep
Cedar shake	$25–$30	~25–35 yrs with maintenance	Classic look; highest maintenance; may sit on skip sheathing
Flat / low-slope (TPO)	$4–$16	~20–30 yrs	For porches, additions, mid-century roofs; ponding shortens life

It's not just the shingle

- **Underlayment:** synthetic underlayment over the whole deck, plus self-adhered ice-and-water membrane at eaves, valleys and around penetrations.
- **Ventilation:** balanced intake (soffit) and exhaust (ridge) vents. In our climate, trapped attic moisture rots decking from below.
- **Flashing:** new step, counter and chimney flashing, lapped so water runs over it. Not caulk.
- **Drip edge and gutters:** they work together; consider replacing aging gutters with the roof.

> **Moss tip:** Oregon State University Extension says moss needs shade to thrive, and trimming nearby trees for more sun is the most effective long-term fix. OSU's pest guide says zinc or copper strips are *not* effective at eliminating moss.

3. What it costs (published estimates)

Measure	Published figure	Source
Portland-area full replacement, typical	$8,211–$23,958	Interstate Roofing, Portland page
Oregon new roof, all materials	$9,300–$27,200	Interstate Roofing, Oregon calculator
Portland/Vancouver, most homes (asphalt, tear-off)	$14,000–$20,000; full range $12,000–$30,000+	Jobin Roofing (Sept 2026)
Portland/Vancouver asphalt, 20–30 square home	$20,000–$36,000	Stanley Roof and Solar
Oregon average	$7,225 avg; $5,639–$18,173	This Old House
National asphalt reroof, 3,000 sq ft roof	$31,871; ~67.5% recouped at resale	Cost vs. Value 2025

Quick math for your home

Roof area ≈ (home sq ft ÷ stories) × 1.15 (low pitch), 1.25 (medium) or 1.45 (steep). Multiply by the material's $/sq ft range on page 2. Example: a 2,000 sq ft two-story with a medium pitch has about 1,250 sq ft of roof; in architectural asphalt that's roughly $5,500–$11,500 by the per-square-foot figures, while local roofers' whole-job ranges above run higher, because tear-off, decking, flashing, permits and disposal add up.

What pushes a bid up

- Steep pitch, multiple stories, hard access
- Extra layers to tear off
- Rotted decking (priced per sheet: get the unit price in writing)
- Chimneys, skylights, dormers, valleys
- Premium materials; storm-season demand

Other common costs

Job	Published range
Roof repair (Portland, most projects)	$372–$1,872
Roof inspection	$100–$400
Gutter installation	$12–$25 per linear foot
Moss removal + treatment (Oregon)	$350–$950
Skylight replacement	$800–$2,400

4. Vetting a roofer in five minutes

Oregon makes this easy. Every contractor who advertises must hold a Construction Contractors Board (CCB) license, and must show the license number on their website and advertising (OAR 812-003-0120).

1. Get the company's exact business name and CCB number.
2. Look it up at **search.ccb.state.or.us**. Confirm the license is **active**, the name matches, and the bond and insurance are current.
3. Check complaint history (or call the CCB at 503-378-4621).
4. Ask how long they've worked in your city, and for addresses of nearby jobs you can drive past.
5. Ask who will be on your roof: their crew or a subcontractor?
6. Confirm they carry workers' compensation if they have employees.

> **Red flags:** no CCB number, or a number that doesn't match the name · door-to-door offers after a storm · pressure to sign today · large cash deposits · a "free roof" promise tied to your insurance claim · no written contract.

The CCB's own advice: never agree to buy services on the spot; get bids from several contractors; get a written contract with a detailed description of work, materials, costs and dates; never pay the full amount up front and don't pay in cash. Using an unlicensed contractor means losing access to the contractor's bond and CCB dispute help.

Questions to ask at the bid appointment

☐ Will you inspect the attic and decking?

☐ Tear-off or layover? Why?

☐ What underlayment, ice-and-water membrane and ventilation will you use?

☐ Will you replace all flashing, boots and vents?

☐ What's the price per sheet for rotted decking?

☐ Who pulls the permit, if one is needed?

☐ What's your workmanship warranty, and is the manufacturer warranty registered?

☐ How do you protect landscaping and clean up nails?

☐ What happens if it rains mid-job?

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5. Reading a bid: the 12 things it should include

- ☐ Business name, address, phone and **CCB number**
- ☐ Scope: tear-off (how many layers) or layover
- ☐ Roofing brand, product line and color
- ☐ Underlayment type; ice-and-water membrane locations
- ☐ Ventilation plan (intake and exhaust)
- ☐ Flashing: chimney, walls, skylights, vents, drip edge
- ☐ Decking: inspection plus the per-sheet replacement price
- ☐ Gutters, skylights, chimney work (included or excluded)
- ☐ Permit: who pulls it and who pays
- ☐ Cleanup, disposal, magnetic nail sweep
- ☐ Payment schedule (never all up front)
- ☐ Written workmanship warranty plus manufacturer warranty

> **Oregon contract basics:** construction agreements for more than $2,000 must be in writing. Residential contractors must give you required consumer notices (such as the Consumer Protection Notice) when you sign. Keep copies.

Comparing bids fairly

Line bids up item by item. A bid that's thousands cheaper often leaves out decking, ventilation, flashing or disposal, which show up later as change orders. Ask each roofer to price the same scope.

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6. Permits, HOAs and trees

Oregon's Building Codes Division lists "applying roofing when all of the old roofing is removed, and all new roof sheathing is installed" as work needing a permit. A reroof that keeps the existing sheathing generally doesn't. Always confirm with your city:

City	Building office
Lake Oswego	Building Division, 503-635-0390
West Linn	Building Division, 503-742-6055
Oregon City	Building Division (Citizen Self Service portal); City Hall 503-657-0891
Gladstone	Clackamas County Building Codes, 503-742-4240 (city approval first)
Milwaukie	Building Division, 503-786-7555

HOAs/CC&Rs can restrict roof materials and colors: get written approval before ordering. **Trees:** Lake Oswego, West Linn and Milwaukie have tree removal permit rules; check before removing a tree over your roof.

Bid comparison worksheet

Item	Roofer A	Roofer B	Roofer C
Business name & CCB # (verified?)			
Total price			
Material brand / line / color			
Tear-off layers included			
Decking price per sheet			
Underlayment + ice & water			
Ventilation plan			
Flashing / skylights / chimney			
Gutters included?			
Permit handled by			
Workmanship warranty (years)			
Payment schedule			
Start date / duration			

7. Insurance and storm damage

- Homeowners policies usually cover **sudden** damage (wind, falling trees, weight of ice and snow) and usually exclude wear, age and maintenance issues such as moss.
- Oregon's Division of Financial Regulation (DFR) notes that if wind blows off a few shingles, insurance will likely replace those shingles, not the entire roof, and if damage is on one slope, insurers normally pay for that slope.
- If a neighbor's tree falls on your house, you still file with **your own** insurer (DFR).
- Document first: photos and video inside and out, before cleanup; keep receipts.
- Trouble with a claim? DFR consumer help line: 888-877-4894.

Storm first steps

1. Safety: stay off the roof; cut power to wet circuits; avoid sagging ceilings.
2. Contain water: buckets, towels, move valuables.
3. Document everything.
4. Call your insurer.
5. Have a licensed roofer tarp or patch.
6. Get written bids for the permanent fix.

8. After the roof: yearly care

☐ Late fall: clean gutters and valleys after leaves drop

☐ Spring: check for moss on shaded slopes; treat gently (no pressure washing)

☐ Trim branches that touch or shade the roof

☐ After big storms: check from the ground for lifted shingles or ridge caps

☐ Every few years: a roofer's inspection, especially as the roof ages

☐ Keep your warranty paperwork, permit sign-off and photos together

Sources (checked October 2026)

Interstate Roofing (interstateroofing.com/or/portland/roofing; /or/roof-cost-calculator) · Jobin Roofing (jobinroofing.com/roof-replacement-cost-vancouver-wa-portland-or) · Stanley Roof and Solar (stanleyroofandsolar.com/new-roof-cost-portland-vancouver) · This Old House, roof replacement cost in Oregon · HomeGuide cost guides (roof replacement, metal, cedar shake, TPO, repair, gutters, roof cleaning, skylights, inspection) · Angi, roof repair cost in Portland · Portland Clean Roof · Remodeling/Zonda Cost vs. Value 2025 · Oregon CCB (oregon.gov/ccb; OAR 812-003-0120) · Oregon Building Codes Division (oregon.gov/bcd) · Oregon Division of Financial Regulation (dfr.oregon.gov) · OSU Extension (extension.oregonstate.edu; solvepestproblems.oregonstate.edu/moss) · city building division websites.

> **Want a licensed roofer to look at your roof?** Call the number at **willamettefallsroofing.com** to talk with a local, CCB-licensed roofer. If we miss you, leave a message and we'll get back to you.

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